

A: Language under the microscope The focus of this section is on the effect of lexical choices and grammatical features in a short written text.	Learners should study a range of texts and genres. They are expected to be able to identify significant features or patterns in a text and to explore their effects. Learners should analyse language features in a range of contexts, exploring the possible effects of contextual factors on the way language is produced in the text and is received and understood by its audience.	• show, in relation to unseen texts, knowledge and understanding of: – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English, including social and historical variation – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts • show knowledge and understanding of how the language levels (above) can be applied to a range of contexts for language use, including: social and individual varieties of English; aspects of language and identity • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses (discourses in this context means extended stretches of communication) • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources.
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Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
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